PHASMOPHOBIA

MASTER FIELD GUIDE

30 ghosts • evidence • hunt behavior • zero-evidence tests • equipment • cursed items • maps • rewards

v0.19.1.0 baseline • Revised October 29, 2026 • Resonance preview included

CRITICAL RULE: Ghost behavior is probabilistic unless this guide labels it as a mechanical rule. Never rule in a ghost from "it was active," "it threw a lot," or one odd hunt. Repeat controlled tests and account for difficulty, hidden evidence, cursed hunts and The Mimic.

By Elhavryn • UNOFFICIAL FAN GUIDE

MIMIC RULE: If you see Ghost Orbs, The Mimic stays possible until its real evidence is handled correctly for your difficulty. Its Orbs are an ability and still appear on true 0-evidence.

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Quick-start contract order

- 1) On entry, find breaker + two escape routes + available official hiding spots before your sanity becomes huntable.
- 2) Find the active ghost area with temperature, EMF/interactions, audio and Orbs; remember the ghost itself can roam away from the favorite room.
- 3) Build a compact evidence station; protect it with crucifix coverage before deliberately dropping sanity.
- 4) Treat the first natural hunt threshold, base footstep speed, LOS behavior, blink pattern and detection range as evidence.
- 5) Run one targeted high-value test for the remaining candidates; repeat if RNG could imitate it.
- 6) Once the answer is good enough, leave alive. A correct ghost and survival are worth more than proving a personality clue for fun.

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1. Core mechanics & hunt survival

EDITION STATUS: Revised October 29, 2026. Released mechanics baseline v0.19.1.0; reported October 21 PS5 cosmetic fix noted separately. Resonance is announced for late November and is not live in this edition. Event weather and Custom settings can change baseline assumptions. See sections 18–19.

Ghost room vs. ghost location

- The favorite/ghost room is the ghost's anchor, not a cage. Most ghosts can roam, interact from nearby positions, event elsewhere and start a hunt from wherever the ghost is physically standing.
- Temperatures follow where the ghost has been; a room that was cold can lag behind a roaming ghost. Orbs are tied to the favorite room, which makes them useful for relocating the anchor after confusion.
- Goryo is the major room-stability exception: it cannot change favorite room and cannot perform long roams. Yurei can be temporarily confined by incense.
- Nell's Diner has a special Cooler Room temperature behavior that can look "ghost-cold"; do not call Freezing until a thermometer confirms ≤0°C / 32°F.

Sanity & hunt thresholds

Situation	Rule / practical use
Standard baseline	Most ghosts can naturally begin hunting when average team sanity is at or below ~50%.
Banshee	Uses its selected target's sanity while that target is inside.
Early hunters	Demon ~70% + rare any-sanity ability; Dayan 65% with moving player near; Raiju 65% near active electronics; Mare 60% in darkness; Onryo ~60%; Gallu 60% enraged; Obambo 65% aggressive; young Thaye ~75%; Kormos can rise to 70% after same-room sprinting.
Late hunters	Shade ~35%; Deogen 40%; Mare 40% in lit room; Dayan 45% with still player near; Gallu 40% weakened; old Thaye can fall toward ~15%; calm Obambo 10%.
Cursed hunt	Cursed possessions can bypass ordinary sanity logic; after a cursed hunt, future hunts remain longer for the contract.
Custom	Starting sanity, evidence count, ghost speed, player speed, grace and many other values can invalidate "standard" assumptions.

How a hunt starts

- Exit doors lock at the beginning of the grace period. The ghost is invisible and stationary during normal grace, then begins its hunting phase.
- Preset grace: Amateur 5 s, Intermediate 4 s, Professional 3 s, Nightmare 2 s, Insanity 2 s. A cursed hunt has 1 s grace unless a custom setting changes the contract.
- Hunts begin from the ghost's physical position, not necessarily the favorite room. The Twins have special hunt-origin behavior.
- After a normal hunt ends, most ghosts need at least ~25 s before another natural attempt; Demon can attempt after ~20 s.
- Crucifix prevents an attempt only if the ghost is in its effective same-floor range when it tries to start. It does not stop a hunt already in progress.

Hunt duration

Preset group	Small	Medium	Large
Amateur (Low)	15 s	30 s	40 s
Intermediate (Medium)	20 s	40 s	50 s
Professional / Nightmare / Insanity (High)	30 s	50 s	60 s
After first cursed hunt	Add 20 s to subsequent hunts in that contract	Add 20 s	Add 20 s
Obambo aggressive-start hunt	20% shorter than the otherwise applicable duration	20% shorter	20% shorter

NIGHTMARE/INSANITY: If "kills extend hunts" is active, a player death can add substantial time. Do not leave hiding merely because the hunt has already felt long.

Ghost detection during hunts

- Sight: most ghosts have 360° visual detection and gradually accelerate while maintaining line of sight. Repeated corners/doors/furniture that fully break sight are more valuable than raw sprint distance.
- Voice: a live microphone can reveal you inside the ghost's normal detection range. Mute/stop speaking before hiding.
- Electronics: powered handheld electronics can reveal your location. Switch them off before entering the hiding spot; dropping an active item can also create a dangerous beacon in the area.

- Exceptions matter: Yokai has very short voice/electronics detection; Kormos is driven heavily by footsteps; Deogen always knows where everyone is; Raiju gains speed around active electronics; Myling is heard from shorter range.

Standard survival sequence

1. BEFORE hunt range: identify at least two escape paths and physically confirm which official hiding spots are available.
2. At hunt start: decide “event or hunt” by door lock/electronic interference/light behavior; do not freeze in the ghost room waiting for certainty.
3. Turn OFF powered handheld electronics and stop talking. Do this before entering the hiding spot.
4. Break line of sight at least once, preferably repeatedly. Do not let the ghost watch you enter your hiding location.
5. Close/hold hiding doors as appropriate. Stay silent until you have a reliable end-of-hunt cue.
6. If detected while exposed: use corners and furniture, save sprint for closing distance to a sight break, and incense before the ghost reaches kill range.
7. Deogen exception: do not hide. Kormos exception: excessive movement/footsteps can be the problem. Aswang exception: correct official hiding can end a hunt.

Events vs. hunts: fast checks

Signal	Ghost event	Hunt
Front/exit door	May close, but not locked by a normal event	Locks at grace-period start
Room lights	Event may switch/shatter/flicker locally	Map lights flicker/interfere near ghost; switches generally cannot be toggled while hunt is active
Electronics	Can interfere during nearby manifestation	Interference follows hunting ghost; dangerous because powered handheld gear can be detected
Ghost	Often appears/approaches as manifestation	Alternates visible/invisible blink and actively pathfinds for players
Your response	Use for photo/video/sound if safe	Survive first; evidence second

2. Evidence deep dive

NEGATIVE EVIDENCE RULE: On 3-evidence settings, a properly executed negative can rule ghosts out. On Nightmare/Insanity/reduced evidence, missing evidence can be intentionally hidden unless it is a forced evidence. On 0 evidence, all standard evidence is hidden; Mimic Orbs still appear.

Evidence	Correct collection	Important traps / special cases
EMF Level 5	Fresh EMF 2/3-eligible interactions have a 33% chance to display EMF 5 if EMF 5 is available. Activity monitor “5 point jumps” are not proof.	Re-test multiple fresh interactions; hunts cause interference.
DOTS	Ghost can enter a DOTS state briefly; cover the actual active area.	Goryo DOTS is camera-only and requires no player in the ghost’s current room.
Ultraviolet	Check fresh door/window/switch/keyboard touches and salt footprints. Charge prints with UV before photo.	Obake can skip UV prints more often and can leave unique prints; absence from one touch is not enough.
Freezing	Thermometer reading ≤0°C / 32°F.	Visible breath alone is not evidence; Hantu has forced freezing on reduced evidence.
Ghost Orbs	Use night vision in the favorite room; scan from multiple angles/rooms if the ghost room may have changed.	Mimic Orbs are extra behavior and persist on 0 evidence.
Ghost Writing	Open/place book inside range. If Writing is available, attempts occur periodically; higher tiers improve success chance/range.	A thrown book without writing is meaningful only when writing is not hidden by difficulty.
Spirit Box	Same room as ghost, within tier range, room lights off; ask recognized questions or use text mode.	Deogen and Moroi have forced Spirit Box on 1–2 evidence; Deogen can give heavy-breath special response.

Forced / special evidence

Ghost	Special rule
Goryo	DOTS guaranteed whenever at least 1 evidence is enabled.
Hantu	Freezing guaranteed whenever at least 1 evidence is enabled.
Moroi	Spirit Box guaranteed whenever at least 1 evidence is enabled.
Obake	UV guaranteed whenever at least 1 evidence is enabled.
Deogen	Spirit Box guaranteed whenever at least 1 evidence is enabled.

Ghost	Special rule
The Mimic	Fake Ghost Orbs always appear, including 0-evidence. Its three real evidences are not individually forced on reduced-evidence settings.

3. Master ghost matrix

HOW TO SCAN: Start with evidence, then sanity threshold, then base hunt speed. “Best tell” is in the dossier section; this matrix is meant to eliminate 80% of choices at a glance.

Ghost	Evidence	Forced/special	Natural hunt threshold	Base / special speed
Aswang	DOTS • Freezing • Writing	—	50%	1.53 m/s base → 2.53 max with fast LOS accel.
Banshee	DOTS • Orbs • UV	—	Target sanity 50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Dayan	EMF 5 • Orbs • Spirit Box	—	45% still nearby / 65% moving nearby / 50% otherwise	1.2 still-near / 2.25 moving-near / standard outside 10 m
Deildegast	EMF 5 • Writing • DOTS	—	50%	3.0 → 0.4 m/s based on moved map props; no LOS accel.
Demon	Writing • UV • Freezing	—	70%; rare ability can hunt at any sanity	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Deogen	DOTS • Writing • Spirit Box	Spirit Box on 1–2 evidence	40%	~3.0 far → ~0.4 very close
Gallu	EMF 5 • UV • Spirit Box	—	40% weakened / 50% normal / 60% enraged	1.36 / 1.70 / 1.955 m/s + normal LOS
Goryo	DOTS • EMF 5 • UV	DOTS on 1–2 evidence	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Hantu	Orbs • UV • Freezing	Freezing on 1–2 evidence	50%	~1.4 warm → ~2.7 freezing; no LOS accel.
Jinn	EMF 5 • UV • Freezing	—	50%	1.7 base; 2.5 at range with breaker ON + LOS
Kormos	Orbs • Spirit Box • UV	—	50%; 70% after same-room sprint trigger	1.7 base; ~2.21 while pursuing heard footsteps; complex LOS
Mare	Writing • Orbs • Spirit Box	—	60% dark / 40% lit	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Moroi	Writing • Freezing • Spirit Box	Spirit Box on 1–2 evidence	50%	~1.5 at high sanity → ~2.25 at 0%; LOS can push ~3.7
Myling	Writing • EMF 5 • UV	—	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Obake	EMF 5 • Orbs • UV	UV on 1–2 evidence	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Obambo	Writing • UV • DOTS	—	10% calm / 65% aggressive	1.445 calm / 1.955 aggressive + normal LOS
Oni	DOTS • EMF 5 • Freezing	—	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Onryo	Orbs • Freezing • Spirit Box	—	~60% normally; flame interactions modify hunt logic	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Phantom	DOTS • UV • Spirit Box	—	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Poltergeist	Writing • UV • Spirit Box	—	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Raiju	DOTS • EMF 5 • Orbs	—	50% normally / 65% near qualifying active electronics	1.7 base / ~2.5 near active electronics
Revenant	Writing • Orbs • Freezing	—	50%	~1.0 searching → ~3.0 after detecting a player
Shade	Writing • EMF 5 • Freezing	—	35%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Spirit	Writing • EMF 5 • Spirit Box	—	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Thaye	DOTS • Writing • Orbs	—	~75% young → ~15% old	~2.75 young → ~1.0 old; fixed by age
The Mimic	UV • Freezing • Spirit Box + fake Orbs	Fake Orbs always, even 0 evidence	Copies current ghost behavior	Copies current ghost behavior
The Twins	EMF 5 • Freezing • Spirit Box	—	50%	~1.53 slow hunt / ~1.87 fast hunt + normal LOS
Wraith	DOTS • EMF 5 • Spirit Box	—	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Yokai	DOTS • Orbs • Spirit Box	—	50% normally; up to ~80% when talking very near it	1.7 m/s + normal LOS
Yurei	DOTS • Orbs • Freezing	—	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS

4. 30 ghost dossiers

Pronunciations are practical English reading aids, not official Kinetic recordings. Capitals mark approximate stress; Japanese vowel length and pitch, Burmese tone and other language-specific sounds cannot be reproduced exactly in English. Where a local reading is uncertain, it is labeled. Cultural origin describes the name or tradition, not a confirmed developer statement of inspiration. Folklore paragraphs describe beliefs and stories, never evidence for identifying a game ghost. F and P references are listed in section 17.

CONFIDENCE LADDER: CONCLUSIVE = a mechanical behavior that cannot normally belong to another ghost under the same conditions. STRONG = highly distinctive but can be confused by settings/state. SUPPORTING = personality/activity clues only. Build answers from at least one strong/conclusive tell plus evidence when possible.

1. Aswang

Pronunciation ahs-WAHNG; Tagalog-based, with ng as in sing. Cebuano often stresses the first syllable.

Cultural origin Philippines; well-attested regional traditions, with several different creature types.

Traditional lore Aswang is an umbrella name for beings described as shapeshifters, witches, corpse eaters, vampires or viscera eaters. Some appear human by day and prey on people at night. The versions differ by language and locality; the manananggal is only one related form. A single universal aswang biography would flatten that diversity. [F1, P1]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • Freezing • Writing	50%	1.53 m/s base → 2.53 max with fast LOS accel.	HIGH if caught in open LOS

Aswang — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Lower base speed, but stronger line-of-sight acceleration than a standard ghost: roughly 0.075× base speed per second instead of 0.05×, reaching max speed in about 8.7 s. After its official hiding-spot weakness ends a hunt, it can move toward the remembered hide during the next grace period; this is not a generic zero-grace rule.
Ability / hidden mechanic	If an Aswang reaches a correctly hidden player in an available official hiding spot, the hunt ends instead of killing that player. It places a waypoint there at the start of the next hunt and can move toward it during grace. Change hides afterward. Community-documented behavior; see section 18.
Best controlled test	Use an official closet/locker/furniture hiding zone that is actually enabled by the hiding-place setting. Unofficial “safe spots” do not count. During an exposed test, listen for a slightly slow opening pace that ramps unusually quickly while it maintains sight.
0-evidence identification	Official hiding-spot survival + unusually rapid LOS acceleration are the key 0-evidence tells. Hiding-place setting = None disables the special weakness.
Common confusion	Slow Twin / calm Obambo can resemble its base pace; a standard ghost can look fast after enough LOS. Test multiple hunts and watch whether the base speed itself changes (Aswang does not).
Survival note	Break sight early. If you have a known official hiding spot, use it correctly; if it ends the hunt, change your plan before the next one.

2. Banshee

Pronunciation BAN-shee; usual English pronunciation.

Cultural origin Ireland; well-attested death-messenger tradition; from Irish bean sí, a woman of the fairy mound.

Traditional lore Her crying or keening foretells or accompanies a death, often within a particular family. She is commonly a lamenting messenger rather than the killer herself. Descriptions of her age and appearance vary. The game’s pursuit of one selected victim is a gameplay adaptation of the association with individuals and families. [F2, F3]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • Orbs • UV	Target sanity 50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Variable; lethal focus in multiplayer

Banshee — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Chooses a hunt target in multiplayer. While that target is inside the investigation area, the Banshee uses the target’s sanity for hunt checks and ignores other players as kill targets. It has an increased preference for singing ghost events.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Can perform a distinctive Banshee scream detected with the Parabolic Microphone / Sound Recorder. A singing-event collision drains more sanity from the target than a normal event.
Best controlled test	In multiplayer, compare who is consistently followed or threatened. Scan paranormal sounds repeatedly for the scream. If a hunt passes through non-target teammates while the target is inside, that is extremely strong Banshee behavior.
0-evidence identification	Unique scream is the cleanest behavior confirmation. Target logic can identify it, but do not manufacture dangerous tests unless the team understands the mechanic.
Common confusion	Phantom also roams toward players; random pathing can fake “following.” The scream is far stronger than personality.
Survival note	If you believe you are the target, play conservatively and carry protection. Non-targets can perform controlled hunt observations while the target remains safely positioned.

3. Dayan

Pronunciation DAA-yun; Hindi-based, two syllables, not DAY-an.

Cultural origin South Asia, especially Hindi-speaking traditions; established witch term with regional variations.

Traditional lore A dayan or daayan is a female witch or dangerous supernatural woman in stories, often associated with harmful magic. Some narratives describe predation, disguise or an outwardly ordinary woman. These are beliefs and storytelling motifs, not a factual category of women. The word's history should not be reduced to a single modern film portrayal. [F4, P2]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
EMF 5 • Orbs • Spirit Box	45% still nearby / 65% moving nearby / 50% otherwise	1.2 still-near / 2.25 moving-near / standard outside 10 m	VERY HIGH when players move near it

Dayan — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Female-only ghost. Its behavior depends on the closest player within 10 m, including a player on another floor. If that player is still, hunt threshold is 45% and hunt speed is fixed at 1.2 m/s. If that player is moving, threshold is 65% and speed is fixed at 2.25 m/s. With nobody within 10 m it behaves at standard 50% threshold and standard speed rules.
Ability / hidden mechanic	LOS acceleration can accumulate "in the background" while the Dayan is near a player and using its fixed proximity speed, then appear once it leaves the 10 m proximity condition.
Best controlled test	During a controlled hunt with a safe loop and incense, compare speed while the nearest player moves versus stands completely still. The change should be immediate and dramatic. Female name/model is supporting exclusion evidence.
0-evidence identification	Movement-linked speed is the strongest tell. Also watch for hunt timing around 65% while people are moving close to the ghost.
Common confusion	Deogen also changes speed by proximity, but it slows because of distance, not player movement, and always knows where you are. Kormos reacts to footsteps but does not use the Dayan 1.2/2.25 fixed pair.
Survival note	Avoid unnecessary movement near the ghost before hunts. During a hunt, use sight breaks and incense rather than trying to "dance" close to it.

4. Deildegast

Pronunciation DAYL-duh-gahst; approximate Norwegian reading, with a hard g.

Cultural origin Norway, particularly southern and western traditions; well-attested boundary-stone revenant.

Traditional lore A person who fraudulently moved a property boundary could return after death, condemned to struggle with the stone and try to restore it. Tales connect the haunting with stolen land and an injustice that remains unsettled. Moving ordinary household props to slow this game ghost is an inventive echo of that boundary-stone motif. [F5]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
EMF 5 • Writing • DOTS	50%	3.0 → 0.4 m/s based on moved map props; no LOS accel.	EXTREME if a hunt starts before you weaken it

Deildegast — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Starts each hunt attempt at a potential 3.0 m/s, then is slowed by 0.1 m/s for each unique qualifying environmental prop that players have moved or interacted with before that attempt, down to 0.4 m/s after 26 qualifying props. Speed cannot be changed mid-hunt.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Qualifying examples include map throwables and many environment interactions such as switches, taps and the fuse box. Player equipment, cursed possessions and doors do not count. Dead players can help. The counter resets after a completed hunt and after a crucifix blocks a hunt attempt.
Best controlled test	Before a controlled hunt, move 13+ unique props; the next hunt should be substantially slower than a fresh 3.0 m/s hunt. Repeat after a crucifix burn to see the reset.
0-evidence identification	A constant, very fast early hunt with no LOS acceleration that becomes deliberately slower after you "trash the map" is highly distinctive.
Common confusion	Young Thaye is fast without LOS but ages across time, not prop count. Revenant switches based on detection. Moroi speed tracks sanity.
Survival note	Treat every hunt attempt as a reset. If you need another hunt, weaken it again before provoking one.

5. Demon

Pronunciation DEE-mun.

Cultural origin Broad religious and literary category; English through Latin from Greek daimōn.

Traditional lore Ancient Greek daimōn could refer to a divine or intermediary power without necessarily meaning an evil being. Later Christian usage strongly emphasized hostile spirits, temptation and possession. Demon traditions vary across religions; the name does not identify one historical monster with a universal appearance or weakness. [F6]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Writing • UV • Freezing	70%; rare ability can hunt at any sanity	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	EXTREME early-hunt threat

Demon — dossier details	
Core mechanics	One of the earliest hunters. Its normal threshold is 70%, and its ability can initiate a hunt regardless of sanity. The minimum hunt cooldown is about 20 s instead of the standard 25 s.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Incense prevents a regular Demon hunt for only 60 s instead of the usual 90 s. Crucifix effective range is 50% larger: T1 4.5 m, T2 6 m, T3 7.5 m.
Best controlled test	At safe sanity, a natural hunt is strong evidence. For controlled identification, time from a successful cleanse: a hunt after ~60 s but before ~90 s supports Demon; a crucifix burning noticeably farther away is another clue.
0-evidence identification	Very early natural hunt + short incense timer + larger crucifix range gives a robust combination. One random early event is not proof.
Common confusion	Thaye and other early hunters can hunt above 50; cursed hunts invalidate threshold logic.
Survival note	Place crucifixes early and keep sanity high until evidence is set. Do not assume setup time or “we should be safe” protects you after cursed-item use.

6. Deogen

Pronunciation DEE-oh-gen; practical English reading with hard g. Dutch de ogen is roughly duh OH-ghun, with a throaty g.

Cultural origin Associated online with Belgium’s Sonian Forest; modern legend with uncertain documentary history.

Traditional lore Retellings describe watching eyes and a mist-like presence in the forest. They often cite a supposed 1937 book and a story of murdered children. That attribution is not securely established by the sources available here; it should not be treated as a verified historical event or an ancient Belgian tradition. “De ogen” means “the eyes.” [F7]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • Writing • Spirit Box | Forced: Spirit Box on 1–2 evidence	40%	~3.0 far → ~0.4 very close	Deadly if you hide; manageable if you loop

Deogen — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Always knows every player’s location during a hunt. It moves extremely fast while far from its target, then slows to a crawl when very close.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Has a special heavy-breathing Spirit Box response when the player is very close. Spirit Box is guaranteed whenever at least one evidence is available.
Best controlled test	If footsteps race straight toward your hiding location from across the map, leave the hiding spot before it reaches you and loop a safe object. The dramatic slow-down at close range is conclusive.
0-evidence identification	Hiding is the test you should NOT complete. Its omniscience plus close-range crawl is unmistakable.
Common confusion	Revenant is the opposite pattern: slow until it detects a player, then extremely fast.
Survival note	Never hide once you know/suspect Deogen. Move to a broad loop, keep the ghost close enough to stay slow, and avoid dead ends.

7. Gallu

Pronunciation GAL-loo; an English approximation of an ancient name.

Cultural origin Ancient Mesopotamia; well-attested underworld demon tradition, related to Sumerian galla and Akkadian gallû.

Traditional lore These beings act as relentless agents of the underworld. In the Inana and Dumuzi cycle, demons accompany Inana out of the realm of the dead and seek a replacement for her. They represent the underworld’s claim on the living, rather than a modern ghost with a human biography. Precise ancient speech is reconstructed. [F8, F9]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
EMF 5 • UV • Spirit Box	40% weakened / 50% normal / 60% enraged	1.36 / 1.70 / 1.955 m/s + normal LOS	HIGH; protection can make it stronger

Gallu — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Has three states. Normal is standard. Protective equipment can push it to Enraged; an enraged hunt that ends turns it Weakened. State changes affect threshold, base speed, incense blind time and crucifix range.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Enraged: 60% threshold, ~1.955 m/s, incense blind 4 s, crucifix range −2 m, and it cannot disturb salt. Weakened: 40%, ~1.36 m/s, incense blind 6 s, crucifix range +1 m. Normal: 50%, 1.7 m/s, 5 s blind. Salt/incense/crucifix can drive state transitions.
Best controlled test	A controlled salt test can be powerful: a normal Gallu may step in salt, then after it enrages it can ignore later piles. Compare hunt speeds across state changes.
0-evidence identification	Protection-linked state changes are the key. A slow hunt after surviving an enraged hunt is especially telling.
Common confusion	Wraith never disturbs salt at all; Gallu can in normal/weakened states. Twins/Obambo can vary speeds but are not directly toggled by protection.
Survival note	Using protection is still worth surviving, but expect a power spike after it takes effect. Plan enough distance to escape after incense wears off.

8. Goryo

Pronunciation goh-ryoh; Japanese goryō, with a longer final oh. Keep ryo together.

Cultural origin Japan; well-attested spirit-veneration and pacification traditions.

Traditional lore Goryō is an honorific name for spirits, especially powerful dead whose resentment was feared to cause disasters or disease. Rites could appease them and transform a dangerous relationship into a protective one. Sugawara no Michizane is a famous example within this wider history. Goryō and onryō overlap culturally; they are not mutually exclusive species. [F10, P3]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • EMF 5 • UV | Forced: DOTS on 1–2 evidence	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Standard hunt danger; difficult behavior ID

Goryo — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Cannot change its favorite room and does not perform long roams. Its DOTS evidence is special: the DOTS silhouette is only visible through a video camera and only while no player is in the ghost's current room.
Ability / hidden mechanic	DOTS is guaranteed on reduced-evidence settings with at least one evidence available. On true 0-evidence, that forced evidence is disabled, making a Goryo one of the harder ghosts to prove.
Best controlled test	Leave the room, watch camera coverage, and look for camera-only DOTS. Compare room stability across a longer contract.
0-evidence identification	No favorite-room change is supportive but slow to prove. Avoid overclaiming Goryo from "it stayed put" in a short match.
Common confusion	Many ghosts can randomly stay in the same room for long periods.
Survival note	Standard survival. Its predictability can help you place crucifix coverage and a safe evidence station.

9. Hantu

Pronunciation HAHN-too; approximate Malay/Indonesian reading.

Cultural origin Malay-speaking and Indonesian-speaking Southeast Asia; broad, well-attested ghost or spirit term.

Traditional lore Hantu occurs in names for many different supernatural beings; their appearances, habitats and relationships with people depend on the particular tradition. It is not inherently the name of one cold-weather creature. The game's temperature-controlled speed therefore belongs to its own design, rather than to a single shared Southeast Asian legend. [F11]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Orbs • UV • Freezing | Forced: Freezing on 1–2 evidence	50%	~1.4 warm → ~2.7 freezing; no LOS accel.	HIGH in cold rooms

Hantu — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Hunt speed is controlled by the temperature of the room it is currently moving through. It is slow in warm areas and can become very fast below freezing. It does not use standard LOS acceleration.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Emits visible freezing breath from the ghost itself during hunts when the fuse box is off. It cannot turn the fuse box on and is more likely to switch it off.

Hantu — dossier details	
Best controlled test	Turn the breaker off and watch a safe hunt from a distance for ghost breath. Compare footsteps as it crosses warm/cold zones.
0-evidence identification	Temperature-linked constant speed + no LOS acceleration is distinctive.
Common confusion	Thaye/Deildegast can have fixed speeds but their speed changes are tied to age/props, not room temperature.
Survival note	Keep breaker on to warm the map when possible. Do not loop a Hantu through a freezing ghost room unless you have a strong escape plan.

10. Jinn

Pronunciation JIN; rhymes with pin.

Cultural origin Arabian and Islamic traditions, with extensive regional traditions beyond Arabia; well-attested.

Traditional lore Jinn are beings distinct from humans and angels, described in Islamic tradition as created from smokeless fire. They may have moral choice and need not be evil; regional stories include helpful, dangerous and deceptive jinn. The lamp-bound wish granter of popular entertainment is only one much narrower image. Electricity and fuse-box rules are game mechanics. [F12]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
EMF 5 • UV • Freezing	50%	1.7 base; 2.5 at range with breaker ON + LOS	HIGH on long sight lines

Jinn — dossier details	
Core mechanics	With the fuse box ON, line of sight, and the target more than roughly 3 m away, the Jinn can move at a fixed ~2.5 m/s until it closes distance or conditions break.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Cannot directly turn the fuse box off. It can use an ability tied to the breaker that drains a nearby player's sanity and produces EMF at/near the fuse box.
Best controlled test	Compare a hunt with breaker ON versus OFF. A sudden fast approach at range that drops back near you is strong Jinn behavior.
0-evidence identification	Breaker-dependent speed burst is the key. "Breaker never turned off" alone is weak because RNG may simply not choose it.
Common confusion	Raiju is fast near active electronics; Hantu speed depends on cold; standard ghosts can build LOS speed gradually rather than snap to Jinn conditions.
Survival note	Break line of sight and/or turn breaker off before deliberate hunt tests. Avoid long hallways when the breaker is on.

11. Kormos

Pronunciation KOR-moss; practical English reading. Körmös has rounded vowels that English spelling only approximates.

Cultural origin Altai and related Turkic traditions; attested spirit terminology, but regional meanings and spellings vary.

Traditional lore Körmös can refer to spirits of the dead and to spirits within shamanic cosmologies; some accounts distinguish different classes and relationships to ancestors or the underworld. It is misleading to turn the term into one universal "Turkish demon." The claim that the name proves a literally blind, footstep-hunting monster is not a secure folklore identification. [F13]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Orbs • Spirit Box • UV	50%; 70% after same-room sprint trigger	1.7 base; ~2.21 while pursuing heard footsteps; complex LOS	VERY HIGH if you panic-run

Kormos — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Nearly blind, but has extreme footstep hearing. During hunts it can hear crouch-walking at about 10 m, walking at ~15 m and sprinting at ~30 m on the same floor. Heard footsteps create waypoints and can speed its approach.
Ability / hidden mechanic	It normally has no standard LOS, but can visually acquire a moving player within ~5 m with a clear path. Outside hunts, sprinting in the same room can raise its hunt threshold to 70%. It cannot perform mist-form or chasing events. Through-wall and excessive-distance killing were fixed in v0.18.0.0; they are not intended abilities.
Best controlled test	Stand completely still in a deliberately safe open position with incense and an escape route ready. A Kormos may fail to visually lock onto you like a normal ghost. Move briefly and listen for the response. Close contact remains lethal; do not assume an intended kill-through-wall ability.
0-evidence identification	Footstep-driven pathing + near blindness is the core tell.
Common confusion	Yokai is "deaf" to voice/electronics at range, but sees normally. Dayan reacts to movement proximity with fixed speed values rather than footstep hearing.
Survival note	Do not sprint unless you must. Crouch-walk only when necessary, then stop completely. Pick a location the ghost is unlikely to wander within 1.5 m of.

12. Mare

Pronunciation MAIR; rhymes with care in English.

Cultural origin Germanic and Scandinavian night-spirit traditions; well-attested, related to the mare in nightmare.

Traditional lore The mare or mara oppresses sleeping people, sometimes described as riding or pressing on the sleeper and bringing frightening dreams. Related accounts concern troubled horses as well. This is a night-being tradition, not the ordinary English word for a female horse. The game uses the darkness association but supplies its own light-switch behavior. [F14]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Writing • Orbs • Spirit Box	60% dark / 40% lit	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	High in dark investigations

Mare — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Hunts earlier when its current room is dark and later when lights are on. It cannot directly turn lights on.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Can use a distinctive ability to immediately switch a light back off soon after a player switches it on; also has strong affinity for light-bulb breaking events.
Best controlled test	Repeatedly use room lights near the ghost. An immediate “nope” switch-off is strong Mare evidence; a long contract in which the ghost never turns a light on is only supporting.
0-evidence identification	Hunt threshold changing with lighting + instant switch-off are the strongest tells.
Common confusion	Any ghost can turn lights off. Breaker loss can create a dark-map false impression.
Survival note	Keep the ghost room and escape route lit when possible. Restore breaker and lighting before deliberately lowering sanity.

13. Moroi

Pronunciation moh-ROY; Romanian-based, with stress on the last syllable.

Cultural origin Romania; well-attested, regionally variable ghost and vampire-related traditions.

Traditional lore Moroi may denote troublesome returning dead; some accounts particularly concern children who died without baptism, while others connect the word with strigoi and harmful supernatural activity. There is no single consistent vampire taxonomy across all Romanian communities. The game’s sanity-linked speed and curse are not historical diagnostic rules. [F15, P4]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Writing • Freezing • Spirit Box | Forced: Spirit Box on 1–2 evidence	50%	~1.5 at high sanity → ~2.25 at 0%; LOS can push ~3.7	EXTREME at low sanity

Moroi — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Its base hunt speed increases as average team sanity falls. At very low sanity it is one of the fastest possible ghosts once LOS acceleration is added.
Ability / hidden mechanic	A successful Spirit Box response or relevant paranormal sound can curse the listener, causing substantially faster passive sanity drain even in lit areas. Sanity medication removes the curse. Incense blinds a Moroi for about 7 s rather than 5 s.
Best controlled test	Track speed across controlled hunts at very different sanity levels. If a player received Spirit Box/paramic evidence and sanity plummets despite light discipline, consider the curse.
0-evidence identification	Sanity-linked speed is the clean tell; do not confuse normal LOS acceleration with a true base-speed change.
Common confusion	Thaye changes with time/age, Deildegast with props, Obambo with timed states.
Survival note	Do not let team sanity collapse. Carry medication and incense; the longer blind duration is useful, but a 0%-sanity Moroi can erase distance rapidly.

14. Myling

Pronunciation MEE-ling is a rough aid; Swedish y is an ee-like vowel spoken with rounded lips.

Cultural origin Sweden and wider Scandinavian dead-child traditions; well-attested.

Traditional lore A myling is commonly the restless ghost of a secretly killed or improperly buried infant. Stories let the child reveal the crime, call for recognition or seek a proper burial; details differ locally. These are tragic tales about concealed death and social obligations, not simply a tradition of unusually quiet adult ghosts. [F16, P5]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Writing • EMF 5 • UV	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Sneaky approach during hunts

Myling — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Its hunt vocalizations and footsteps are audible from a shorter range than normal—about 12 m versus roughly 20 m for a standard ghost.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Produces paranormal sounds more often, making sound-recording / parabolic work more active.
Best controlled test	Classic flashlight-interference test: while safely hidden, compare when your held/near electronic interference begins versus when footsteps become audible. With a Myling, interference can begin before you hear it.
0-evidence identification	Short hunt-audio range is the core behavior tell. Use repeated hunts because walls/floors/audio settings can muddy one sample.
Common confusion	A quiet ghost or obstructed audio can fake it.
Survival note	Do not rely on hearing alone to judge distance. Watch electronics/interference and use prepared hiding routes.

15. Obake

Pronunciation oh-bah-keh; three Japanese syllables, final eh rather than ay.

Cultural origin Japan; well-attested broad word associated with transformation, apparitions and uncanny beings.

Traditional lore Obake and bakemono are connected with changing or transforming. They can describe shapeshifting creatures and, in everyday use, ghosts or monsters more broadly. An obake is not invariably a dead human or a creature with extra fingers. The game's changing model draws on the transformation theme; its fingerprints are a game-specific clue. [F17, P6]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
EMF 5 • Orbs • UV | Forced: UV on 1–2 evidence	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Standard speed; strong visual tells

Obake — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Has a reduced chance to leave UV evidence on eligible interactions, and its UV marks fade faster. It can leave unique abnormal prints such as a six-finger handprint.
Ability / hidden mechanic	During a hunt, it can briefly shapeshift into another ghost model for a blink. UV is guaranteed on reduced-evidence modes with at least one evidence.
Best controlled test	Check every eligible UV interaction carefully and learn the abnormal print patterns. During safe hunt observation, watch for a one-blink model change.
0-evidence identification	Hunt shapeshift is the conclusive 0-evidence test.
Common confusion	Missing UV once is not exclusion; Obake is specifically allowed to skip prints more often.
Survival note	Standard hunt survival. If hunt testing, view from a safe loop/hiding observation angle and prioritize survival over staring at the model.

16. Obambo

Pronunciation oh-BAHM-boh; tentative English reading, not a verified local-language pronunciation.

Cultural origin Equatorial west-central Africa, especially historical accounts from the Gabon region; attested name with a limited and mediated source record.

Traditional lore Older accounts use Obambou for a spirit associated with possession or the unsettled dead. One tradition describes a wandering spirit asking relatives for a small dwelling near their home. Colonial writers often imposed words such as "devil" on local beliefs, so these reports need context and should not be generalized to all African cultures. [F18, F19]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Writing • UV • DOTS	10% calm / 65% aggressive	1.445 calm / 1.955 aggressive + normal LOS	State-dependent; aggressive state dangerous early

Obambo — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Always begins calm. One minute after the exit door is first opened it switches state, then flips every two minutes (community-documented timing). It can change state during a hunt. Calm has high ambient activity but a 10% hunt threshold and slow base speed; aggressive has lower ambient activity but a 65% threshold and fast base speed.

Obambo — dossier details	
Ability / hidden mechanic	A hunt that begins while aggressive is 20% shorter, even if the ghost switches state mid-hunt.
Best controlled test	Time activity phases and hunt speed. A sudden mid-hunt base-speed snap with no obvious LOS cause is strong. On a known map/difficulty, time an aggressive-start hunt for the 20% shorter duration.
0-evidence identification	Timed two-state cycle + opposite activity/aggression pattern is the signature.
Common confusion	Twins can produce two hunt base speeds; Gallu also has states; neither flips on Obambo's timed cycle.
Survival note	Do not mistake a "quiet" aggressive phase for safety. At 65% it may hunt while barely interacting.

17. Oni

Pronunciation oh-nee; two Japanese syllables.

Cultural origin Japan; well-attested, diverse ogre and demon traditions.

Traditional lore Oni are often pictured as large horned beings carrying clubs and wearing tiger-skin clothing. Stories portray frightening attackers or punishers, while some local traditions allow protective or more sympathetic roles. They are not all ghosts of dead humans. Their strength and imposing appearance are cultural motifs; the game's visibility and event restrictions are separate. [F20]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • EMF 5 • Freezing	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Standard speed; conspicuous manifestations

Oni — dossier details	
Core mechanics	More visible during hunts, spending a greater fraction of its blink cycle visible. It cannot perform the mist/airball ghost event.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Oni ghost events are intense. As of v0.19.0.0, the intended sanity drain on collision during singing manifestations is 20% (the patch fixed a prior 10% bug).
Best controlled test	Watch hunt blink visibility from safety and note event type history. A ghost that repeatedly manifests but never does an airball supports Oni; one missing event type is not proof.
0-evidence identification	Very visible hunt blinking + impossible airball event are the core behavior set.
Common confusion	Phantom is the opposite blink extreme—much longer invisible periods.
Survival note	Standard survival. Treat frequent manifestations as sanity pressure even if it is not hunting yet.

18. Onryo

Pronunciation ohn-ryoh; Japanese onryō, with a longer final oh. Keep ryo together.

Cultural origin Japan; well-attested vengeful-spirit tradition.

Traditional lore An onryō is a spirit whose grievance or resentment brings harm after death. Historical accounts link such spirits with calamity and efforts at ritual pacification; theater and later horror fiction develop more personal revenge narratives. Both male and female figures occur. The game's fear of flames and candle-count rules do not define the traditional onryō. [F10, F21, P7]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Orbs • Freezing • Spirit Box	~60% normally; flame interactions modify hunt logic	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Can force hunts through flame count

Onryo — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Lit firelights near the ghost can block hunt attempts, taking priority over crucifixes. A blocked attempt extinguishes a flame. The ghost also tracks extinguished flames; a repeated "third flame" pattern can trigger a hunt at any sanity.
Ability / hidden mechanic	In practical testing, flames are both protection and a trigger. This creates the classic Onryo candle test: controlled flames near crucifix coverage and careful counting.
Best controlled test	Set multiple firelights near the ghost with crucifix backup. Track each extinguish and whether a hunt tries to fire on/after the third counted flame. Reset your assumptions after complex cursed-item or room-change behavior.
0-evidence identification	Consistent flame-block/hunt behavior is the main proof.
Common confusion	Any ghost can blow out candles; random timing can fake the "third candle" if you do not count carefully.
Survival note	Never run an Onryo test without crucifix coverage and an escape route. Flames are not unconditional safety.

19. Phantom

Pronunciation FAN-tum.

Cultural origin European literary and ordinary-language term with Greek roots; broad apparition category.

Traditional lore A phantom is an appearance or specter, often the seeming presence of someone absent or dead. Stories may make such an apparition a warning, a memory or a frightening visitor. The word does not specify one culture's creature or a consistent behavior pattern. Disappearing in a photograph is a Phasmophobia rule, not a dictionary definition. [F22]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • UV • Spirit Box	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Harder to track visually in a hunt

Phantom — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Spends longer invisible during hunt blink cycles, making it look like it "teleports" between visible flashes. Looking at a manifested Phantom drains sanity faster.
Ability / hidden mechanic	A successful ghost photo during a manifestation makes the Phantom disappear visually while the event can continue; the photo can lack the visible ghost model.
Best controlled test	Take a clean ghost photo during an event and watch for disappearance. During a hunt, compare its long invisible blink windows against Oni/standard.
0-evidence identification	Photo disappearance or characteristic blink pattern are strong.
Common confusion	Oni is unusually visible; bad lighting can make any ghost seem invisible.
Survival note	Do not stare longer than needed. Hunt by sound/route, not visual tracking alone.

20. Poltergeist

Pronunciation POHL-ter-gyst; gyst rhymes with heist.

Cultural origin German term and wider European haunting traditions; well-attested name for a noisy spirit or disturbance.

Traditional lore Accounts focus on knocks, thrown objects and seemingly unexplained physical disruption. The German components refer to making a racket and to a spirit. Later psychical-research literature also debated explanations other than a dead person's ghost. The game's object-throwing theme echoes these accounts, but precise probabilities and sanity effects are invented mechanics. [F3, F23]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Writing • UV • Spirit Box	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Sanity damage from object-heavy rooms

Poltergeist — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Has an exceptionally high relationship with throwable objects and can throw multiple nearby props essentially at once. During hunts it throws environmental objects much more frequently than most ghosts.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Its multi-object throw can drain sanity based on the number of affected objects.
Best controlled test	Build a "polty pile" of many small throwables in the active room and watch from safety. A simultaneous explosive spread is the classic confirmation.
0-evidence identification	Multi-throw is highly distinctive when clearly observed.
Common confusion	High RNG activity can make any ghost seem throw-happy; one thrown cup proves nothing.
Survival note	Do not loiter at low sanity in a prop-rich room just to farm activity. Set the pile, back off, and observe.

21. Raiju

Pronunciation rye-joo; Japanese raijū, with a longer final oo.

Cultural origin Japan; well-attested thunder-beast tradition.

Traditional lore Raijū are beasts associated with thunderstorms and lightning. Historical depictions vary from small mammal-like creatures to stranger composite forms; there is no single required animal shape. They give lightning an animal presence in story and image. The game extends the storm association into modern electronic equipment, which is a thematic adaptation. [F24, P8]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • EMF 5 • Orbs	50% normally / 65% near qualifying active electronics	1.7 base / ~2.5 near active electronics	EXTREME around an evidence station

Raiju — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Active qualifying electronics near the ghost raise its hunt threshold and set a fast hunt speed around 2.5 m/s. Its electronic interference radius is also larger than normal.
Ability / hidden mechanic	The danger follows electronics in the environment, not just the item in your hand. An evidence station full of powered gear can turn the favorite room into a speed zone.
Best controlled test	During a controlled hunt, compare footsteps as it enters/leaves the radius of clearly active electronics. You should hear a sharp speed change.
0-evidence identification	Electronics-linked speed zone + larger interference range is the signature.
Common confusion	Jinn is fast at range with breaker ON; Moroi/Thaye can simply be fast.
Survival note	Turn off/drop unnecessary active electronics before provoking hunts and do not hide beside powered equipment.

22. Revenant

Pronunciation REV-uh-nunt; usual English reading.

Cultural origin European returning-dead traditions; English borrowed from French revenant, one who returns.

Traditional lore Medieval and later stories describe dead people returning, sometimes bodily and sometimes as apparitions, to trouble the living. Unresolved wrongdoing, death and burial can matter, but accounts differ. “Revenant” names the return rather than a fixed ability set; the game’s slow-searching and fast-chasing phases are not a universal folklore pattern. [F3, F25]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Writing • Orbs • Freezing	50%	~1.0 searching → ~3.0 after detecting a player	EXTREME once detected

Revenant — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Very slow while it has no player detection waypoint, but rockets to about 3.0 m/s after detecting a player through sight, voice or electronics.
Ability / hidden mechanic	The signature is not just “fast ghost”—it is the enormous switch between slow searching and fast pursuit.
Best controlled test	Listen from a safe, silent hiding spot. If footsteps are abnormally slow, then become extremely fast after a deliberate distant detection and later slow again, Revenant is very likely.
0-evidence identification	Slow-to-instant-fast transition is one of the cleanest 0-evidence tells.
Common confusion	Deogen starts fast toward hidden players then slows close—the opposite. Deildegast can be 3.0 from hunt start but remains constant for that hunt.
Survival note	Never let it detect you unless you already have distance, incense and a route. Electronics discipline matters enormously.

23. Shade

Pronunciation SHAYD.

Cultural origin English literary ghost term, used especially of the dead in classical-underworld writing and translation.

Traditional lore A shade is the shadow-like presence or soul of a dead person. The term evokes an insubstantial continuation of life rather than one named monster. A shade may speak or retain memory in literary accounts; shyness, low activity and reluctance to hunt near people are the game’s specialization of the word. [F26]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Writing • EMF 5 • Freezing	35%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Later hunter, but behavior can be misleading

Shade — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Extremely shy. Its interactions and events are strongly suppressed around players, and it cannot initiate a hunt while a player is in the same room as the ghost’s actual current location.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Late natural hunt threshold (~35%) is one of the strongest statistical clues. However, room boundaries and ghost roaming can make “same room” tests look inconsistent.
Best controlled test	At low sanity, stay in the correctly identified current room while protected and observe whether hunt attempts only occur after the ghost roams out. Use motion/EMF to understand location rather than favorite-room label alone.
0-evidence identification	Late hunt + persistent player-proximity suppression is the behavior package.
Common confusion	Any ghost can be passive by RNG. “It did nothing for five minutes” is not a Shade test.
Survival note	Its late threshold gives more setup time, but do not become complacent once team sanity crosses the mid-30s.

24. Spirit

Pronunciation SPIR-it.

Cultural origin Broad cross-cultural concept; English word through Latin spiritus, breath or spirit.

Traditional lore Spirit can mean a soul, an incorporeal being or a nonhuman supernatural presence depending on the religion and context. Stories of the dead lingering through attachment or unfinished obligations occur in many places, but should not be treated as one universal doctrine. Phasmophobia gives this very broad label a specific evidence combination and incense timer. [F27]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
Writing • EMF 5 • Spirit Box	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Standard

Spirit — dossier details	
Core mechanics	The baseline ghost with one major hidden mechanic: after a successful incense cleanse outside a hunt, it cannot start a regular hunt for about 180 s instead of the usual 90 s.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Otherwise behaves close to standard mechanics, so it is often identified by exclusion or the incense timer.
Best controlled test	Cleanse the ghost correctly, start a timer from the actual successful cleanse, and maintain hunt-eligible sanity. If no hunt occurs for roughly three minutes, Spirit rises sharply in probability.
0-evidence identification	Incense timer is the strongest behavior test.
Common confusion	Bad cleanse placement can produce a false timer. Demon is the short 60 s opposite.
Survival note	Standard survival. Use the long post-cleanse safety window to finish objectives rather than waiting in danger.

25. Thaye

Pronunciation thuh-YEH; two syllables, th as in thin; Burmese tone is only approximated.

Cultural origin Myanmar; established Burmese word for ghost, with varied local and Buddhist-influenced traditions.

Traditional lore Thayé is not one uniquely named individual. Accounts of these ghosts describe frightening or troublesome dead, sometimes linked to illness and unsettled relationships with the living. Appearances and explanations vary, and the word should not be equated with the entire nat tradition. Rapidly aging when investigators remain nearby is the game's invention. [F28, P9]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • Writing • Orbs	~75% young → ~15% old	~2.75 young → ~1.0 old; fixed by age	EXTREME early; weak late

Thaye — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Ages when players spend time near it. With age it becomes slower, less active, and hunts at lower and lower sanity. It starts among the fastest and earliest hunters and can end as one of the slowest/least aggressive.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Its age can be queried with the Ouija Board; repeated age answers can confirm progression. It does not gain normal LOS acceleration because its hunt speed is age-defined.
Best controlled test	Compare an early hunt to a much later hunt after spending time near the ghost. A large, progressive slowdown is classic Thaye.
0-evidence identification	Time/age-linked progressive slowdown is the signature.
Common confusion	Obambo flips states back and forth; Deildegast resets per hunt and responds to props. Thaye trends one direction over the contract.
Survival note	Treat a fresh Thaye like an emergency. Get protection down early; if you survive long enough near it, later hunts become easier.

26. The Mimic

Pronunciation thuh MIM-ik.

Cultural origin English descriptive label used as a game type; imitation is a widespread story motif.

Traditional lore Doubles, deceivers and shapeshifters appear in many traditions, but that does not establish a single historical ghost species called "The Mimic." The game makes imitation into a distinct mechanical identity. Its false Orbs and changing copied behaviors are part of that design; a connection to any particular folklore figure needs separate evidence. [F29, G2]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
UV • Freezing • Spirit Box + fake Orbs | Forced: Fake Orbs always, even 0 evidence	Copies current ghost behavior	Copies current ghost behavior	UNPREDICTABLE

The Mimic — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Can imitate the behavior, hunt threshold, speed and abilities of other ghosts, changing mimic target periodically. It does not change type mid-hunt. Ghost Orbs are an extra ability, not one of its three standard evidences, and appear even on 0-evidence settings.
Ability / hidden mechanic	Because it copies behavior, a Mimic can produce “impossible” combinations across a contract: e.g., one hunt looks like a Deogen, a later hunt like a Hantu. It also retains certain internal counters/ongoing effects in ways that can make advanced tests messy.
Best controlled test	Whenever Orbs are present, keep Mimic open until UV + Freezing + Spirit Box have been checked according to difficulty. On 0 evidence, Orbs themselves are the giveaway because normal evidence is disabled but Mimic Orbs remain.
0-evidence identification	Ghost Orbs on true 0-evidence = Mimic. In reduced evidence, contradictory changing behavior plus Orbs is suspicious.
Common confusion	Every ghost—it is designed to impersonate them.
Survival note	Never rely on one hunt’s behavior as a permanent safety rule. A Mimic can change into a much more dangerous ghost before the next hunt.

27. The Twins

Pronunciation thuh TWINZ.

Cultural origin English descriptive label used as a game type; no single established folklore origin is specified.

Traditional lore Twin figures can be divine, heroic, ominous or ordinary across different traditions. A generic motif is not evidence that this ghost derives from a particular pair of mythological twins or from a film’s imagery. Phasmophobia’s two-range interactions belong to its fictional type; they do not demonstrate two separate historical spirits. [F30, G2]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
EMF 5 • Freezing • Spirit Box	50%	~1.53 slow hunt / ~1.87 fast hunt + normal LOS	Unpredictable hunt origin and pace

The Twins — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Mechanically one ghost with two interaction ranges / “twin” behavior. It can create interactions far apart in a short window and hunts can originate from different effective locations. Hunt base speed is chosen from a slower or faster twin value.
Ability / hidden mechanic	The speed alternation is moderate—not the extreme Revenant/Deogen type. Activity-monitor “twinteraction” patterns are supporting, not conclusive.
Best controlled test	Compare several hunts. If one is consistently a little slow and another a little fast at base before LOS buildup, Twins is plausible. Track widely separated interaction timing.
0-evidence identification	Alternating mild hunt speeds across multiple hunts is the strongest behavior clue.
Common confusion	Aswang starts around slow-Twin pace; Obambo uses similar two speeds but on a timed state system and can change mid-hunt.
Survival note	Do not assume the ghost will hunt from the favorite room. Keep routes safe from adjacent/remote interaction areas.

28. Wraith

Pronunciation RAYTH; silent w, th as in thin.

Cultural origin Scots and Scottish literary usage; well-attested apparition term, with uncertain deeper etymology.

Traditional lore A wraith can be the likeness of a living person seen as a death omen, or an apparition of someone dead. Later fantasy often makes wraiths uniformly sinister, but that is not the whole history of the word. Floating, teleporting and avoiding salt are the game’s particular interpretation. [F3, F31]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • EMF 5 • Spirit Box	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Teleport ability can place it near players

Wraith — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Never disturbs salt. It can teleport near a player outside hunts, creating an EMF reading near the destination and potentially causing sudden activity away from the favorite room.

Wraith — dossier details	
Ability / hidden mechanic	Salt immunity is a physical mechanic, not a personality tendency. However, an enraged Gallu can also fail to disturb salt, so context matters in the expanded ghost pool.
Best controlled test	Place salt directly in likely ghost pathing, ideally use motion evidence to confirm it walked through. If it repeatedly crosses without disturbing salt from a neutral state, Wraith is a top suspect.
0-evidence identification	Verified salt pass-through is the classic test.
Common confusion	Enraged Gallu can ignore salt temporarily; be aware of recent crucifix/incense/salt state changes.
Survival note	Do not assume distance from the favorite room means safety; teleport activity can move the ghost close before a hunt.

29. Yokai

Pronunciation yoh-kye; Japanese yōkai, with a longer first oh.

Cultural origin Japan; well-attested umbrella category of uncanny beings and phenomena.

Traditional lore Yōkai can include shapeshifting animals, animated objects, oni and many other strange presences. The category has changed over time and is not simply a synonym for one species of human ghost. Traditions can be comic, unsettling or dangerous. The game's sensitivity to nearby speech and poor hunt detection do not describe yōkai as a whole. [F17, F20, P10]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • Orbs • Spirit Box	50% normally; up to ~80% when talking very near it	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Early hunt if team talks in its face

Yokai — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Nearby player voice can raise its hunt threshold dramatically. During hunts it has very poor detection range for voice and active handheld electronics—roughly 2.5 m instead of the much larger normal range. Visual detection remains normal.
Ability / hidden mechanic	The famous "deaf ghost" test only works if you are out of sight; if it can see you, it will chase normally.
Best controlled test	From a safe hidden position outside visual LOS, use a controlled active electronic/voice bait at a distance that a normal ghost should detect. If it repeatedly ignores the signal until very close, Yokai is likely.
0-evidence identification	Short voice/electronics detection is the best tell.
Common confusion	Kormos has special footstep hearing but near-blind vision; Yokai's weakness is voice/electronics, not footsteps.
Survival note	Once hidden and out of sight, stay quiet/off anyway. Do not talk near the ghost at high sanity unless you are intentionally testing.

30. Yurei

Pronunciation yoo-ray; Japanese yūrei, with a longer first oo.

Cultural origin Japan; well-attested term for spirits of the dead, with changing historical meanings.

Traditional lore Unresolved attachments and emotions often keep a yūrei connected to the living in stories. The familiar white burial clothing, loose hair and absent feet are conventions of particular artistic and theatrical traditions, not a universal appearance. Vengeful spirits overlap with this category. Door-slamming and measured sanity loss remain game rules. [F21, P11]

Gameplay Evidence, tests and survival rules below describe Phasmophobia.

Evidence	Hunt threshold	Hunt speed	Danger
DOTS • Orbs • Freezing	50%	1.7 m/s + normal LOS	Sanity drain and door ability

Yurei — dossier details	
Core mechanics	Can use a door-closing ability that fully closes a nearby open door and drains about 15% sanity from players near the ghost. It is one of the few ways the front/exit door can be manipulated outside a hunt/event context.
Ability / hidden mechanic	A successful incense cleanse also forces a Yurei back to its favorite room and prevents it from roaming out for about 90 s, though events can still occur elsewhere.
Best controlled test	Watch for a distinct full door slam/close paired with sanity loss and no event. After cleansing, use motion/room activity to test temporary confinement.
0-evidence identification	Door ability is the strongest tell, but it is RNG-gated—lack of a slam is not exclusion.
Common confusion	Normal ghosts touch doors constantly; only the specific full-close + sanity-drain behavior is meaningful.
Survival note	Standard survival. Use the post-incense confinement to stabilize evidence equipment and complete room-based tests.

5. Hunt-identification indexes

Speed families

What you hear	Think first	How to separate
Very slow until detection, then ~3.0	Revenant	Detection-triggered switch.
~3.0 far, crawls close	Deogen	Always knows player location; never hide.
Starts up to 3.0, constant within hunt; prop-controlled between hunts	Deildegast	Move unique map props before next attempt.
2.75-ish early, trends slower over contract	Thaye	Ages one direction with player proximity.
Speed follows room temperature	Hantu	No normal LOS accel; cold = faster.
Speed follows average sanity	Moroi	Lower team sanity = higher base speed.
Fast only near active electronics	Raiju	Sharp speed zone around electronics.
Fast at distance with breaker ON + LOS	Jinn	Drops out when close/breaker off.
1.2 or 2.25 based on nearby player still/moving	Dayan	Movement-linked within 10 m.
Two mild base speeds across hunts	Twins	~1.53 vs ~1.87; remote interactions.
Timed calm/aggressive speeds	Obambo	1.445 vs 1.955; state flips every ~2 min.
Protection-linked slow/normal/fast states	Gallu	1.36 / 1.7 / 1.955; state equipment interaction.
1.53 base but unusually fast LOS buildup	Aswang	Reaches ~2.53 max faster than standard.
Fast toward heard footsteps / near-blind	Kormos	Stop moving; footstep ranges are distinctive.

Blink / visibility families

Observation	Ghost / interpretation
Long invisible gaps during hunt	Phantom.
Unusually visible / short invisible gaps	Oni.
One-blink model change	Obake shapeshift.
Visible ghost breath with breaker off	Hantu (during hunt).
Any ghost looks “invisible” because lighting is bad	Do not call Phantom without repeated blink timing or photo test.

Sound / detection families

Observation	Think
Hunt footsteps/vocals only audible unusually close	Myling.
Voice/electronics bait ignored until very close while out of LOS	Yokai.
Footsteps cause long-range pursuit; still player can be nearly invisible	Kormos.
Unique scream in paranormal audio	Banshee.
Spirit Box / paranormal sound followed by abnormal sanity drain	Moroi curse.

Object / door / light families

Observation	Think
Multi-object explosive throw	Poltergeist.
Instantly switches a just-turned-on room light back off	Mare.
Full door-close ability + nearby sanity drain	Yurei.
Never disturbs salt	Wraith — unless Gallu state context explains it.
Salt works once, then ghost ignores later piles after protection/state shift	Gallu.
Camera-only DOTS with room empty	Goryo.
Repeated flame extinguishes / hunt blocks tied to firelight count	Onryo.

6. Equipment & tier mechanics

TIER PRINCIPLE: Higher tier is not always “better” for every test. Tier II UV is non-electronic and can be hunt-safe light; Tier I incense lets a blinded fast ghost keep moving away rather than freezing near you; Tier I thermometer is passive/non-electronic.

Evidence equipment

Tool	Tier I	Tier II	Tier III	Field notes
EMF Reader	Basic short-range analog	Improved digital	Longer-range / directional display	True EMF 5 is evidence; hunt interference can mask readings.
DOTS	$65; 5 m narrow spotlight	$65; 2.5 m area	$65; 7 m wide scanning	Place for ghost pathing, not just favorite-room center. Goryo camera rule.
UV Light	$35; narrow electronic; 5 s charge	$35; glowstick, 60 s light, 10 s charge; non-electronic	$35; wide electronic; 1.5 s charge	Glowstick is excellent hunt-safe illumination.
Thermometer	$30; passive, 0.33°C/s; non-electronic	$30; 2.5 s sample; electronic	$30; 1.5 s sample; higher accuracy	Freezing is ≤0°C / 32°F; visible breath is not proof.
Video Camera	$50; low image/resistance	$50; medium	$50; high	Night vision for Orbs; higher tiers resist paranormal interference better.
Ghost Writing Book	3 m range; ~51% success per writing attempt	4 m; ~67%	5 m; ~76%	If Writing is available, ghost attempts periodically (about 45–90 s).
Spirit Box	3 m response range	4 m	5 m	Same room as ghost + lights off; text mode is useful when voice recognition is unreliable.

Protection / support equipment

Tool	Tier mechanics	Expert use
Crucifix	T1: 3 m / 1 use. T2: 4 m / 2 uses. T3: 5 m / 2 uses; unused T3 can stop one cursed hunt by consuming both uses.	Works through walls/doors but same-floor geometry matters. Demon +50% range. Gallu changes range by state.
Incense	T1 range 3 m, burn 5 s. T2 4 m/6 s + slows ghost to 50% during 5 s blind. T3 5 m/7 s + halts ghost during initial 5 s blind.	Regular hunt-prevention timer: Demon 60 s, Spirit 180 s, others 90 s. Hunt blind: most 5 s; Gallu enraged 4 / weakened 6; Moroi 7.
Salt	Tiers increase uses/effects; T3 can slow a hunting ghost temporarily.	Wraith never disturbs it; enraged Gallu also ignores it. Use path confirmation before drawing conclusions.
Firelight	Higher tiers last longer / reduce passive sanity drain more strongly; T3 is indefinite and weatherproof.	Core Onryo test/protection tool. Lighting the ghost room can conserve sanity while gathering evidence.
Sanity Medication	Preset restore: Amateur 40%, Intermediate 35%, Professional 30%, Nightmare 25%, Insanity 20%; higher tiers restore faster; T3 adds temporary movement/stamina boost.	Moroi curse is removed by medication. Coordinate team doses instead of wasting pills at high sanity.
Parabolic Microphone	Higher tiers increase reach/features; T3 has advanced directional/sonar-style behavior.	Banshee scream; Myling produces paranormal sounds more often; Moroi can curse via paranormal sound.
Motion Sensor	Higher tiers expand shape/coverage; T3 can scan a broader area.	Confirm ghost path through salt, track room roaming, establish where a Shade actually is.
Photo Camera	T1 3 s cooldown; T2 2 s; T3 1 s. Only first 5 photos count in the journal.	Phantom photo test; capture bone, cursed item, interactions, crucifix, writing, UV, etc. v0.19 marks duplicate evidence.
Sound Recorder	Records unique paranormal sounds; higher tiers improve visual feedback/range.	Useful for Banshee/Myling/Moroi mechanics and Chronicle media rewards.
Head Gear	T1 head camera; T2 head-mounted LED; T3 night-vision goggles.	T1 can let truck player scan Orbs; T3 vision helps dark navigation but remains electronic.
Tripod	Stability and motorized features improve by tier.	Place video at eye-height/clean angle; ghosts can knock cameras over.
Sound Sensor	Remote area audio to truck monitor.	Released baseline: remote area audio on the truck monitor for triangulation. The announced Resonance map/UI rework is future content; see section 19.

7. Cursed possessions

UNIVERSAL CURSED RULE: Using a cursed possession immediately cancels setup protection. A cursed hunt has 1 s grace and makes future hunts in that contract 20 s longer. Do not touch a cursed item until you know an escape route unless you are intentionally gambling.

Item	Exact value / trigger	Best use	Main danger
Haunted Mirror	Shows current favorite room. Sanity drains ~7.5%/s, with a minimum cost per use; can break and curse-hunt at critically low sanity.	Instant room location on large maps.	Staring too long can zero sanity and trigger a cursed hunt in your hands.
Ouija Board	Question costs vary. Room/location is expensive (~50%); many basic questions ~5%; bone location ~20%. Say “Goodbye” before leaving it.	Find room/bone, age a Thaye, gather media.	Board can break and cursed-hunt if abandoned while active, used without enough sanity, or during Hide and Seek.

Item	Exact value / trigger	Best use	Main danger
Music Box	Ghost sings within range; close proximity can manifest/walk toward the box.	Locate ghost and force a visible event.	Getting too close, dropping/throwing it while active, prolonged walk or reaching 0 sanity can trigger cursed hunt.
Summoning Circle	5 candles, each costs 16% sanity; completing circle summons ghost for ~5 s then cursed hunt.	Guaranteed ghost media / objectives after identification.	Very expensive sanity cost; if you cannot pay, behavior can collapse into immediate danger.
Tarot Cards	10 cards, random effects.	Powerful event/revive/sanity manipulation and media.	Death = cursed hunt; Hanged Man = death; probabilities mean there is no “safe” draw.
Voodoo Doll	Normal pins force interactions for sanity cost; heart pin triggers cursed hunt.	Force doors/throws to gather EMF/UV/writing opportunities.	Heart pin can fire unexpectedly depending on pin order/sanity.
Monkey Paw	3–5 wishes depending on difficulty multiplier; each wish once.	Targeted rule-breaking: knowledge, revive, leave, weather, activity, etc.	Every wish has a penalty; several directly force hunts or permanent contract debuffs.

Tarot Cards: probabilities & effects

Card	Approx. chance	Effect
The Tower	20%	Strongly increases potential ghost activity for ~20 s.
Wheel of Fortune	20%	Green/red outcome: +25 or −25 sanity.
The Fool	17% normally; replaces draws during hunts	Appears as another card then becomes Fool; no effect.
The Devil	10%	Triggers a ghost event near the nearest player.
Death	10%	Starts a cursed hunt.
The Hermit	10%	Forces ghost to favorite room / suppresses roaming for about 1 min.
The Sun	5%	Sets player sanity to 100%.
The Moon	5%	Sets player sanity to 0%.
The High Priestess	2%	Revives the first dead player or reserves a future revive if nobody is dead.
The Hanged Man	1%	Kills the drawer immediately.

Monkey Paw wishes: practical consequence sheet

Wish	Benefit	Cost / danger
I wish to see the ghost	Forces a summoning-style manifestation at ghost location.	Exits lock; after ~5 s a cursed hunt begins; wisher suffers darkened vision.
I wish for activity	Greatly increases activity for ~2 min.	Fuse box breaks permanently and exits lock for ~2 min.
I wish to trap the ghost	Cleanses / traps ghost in favorite room about 1 min.	Nearby doors lock; after trap ends a hunt follows.
I wish for sanity	Sets all players to ~50% sanity.	Passive sanity drain is increased for rest of contract and favorite room can change (even affecting Goryo’s normal limitation).
I wish to be safe	Opens nearest blocked hiding spot.	Lights in current room shatter; ghost gains exceptional ability to sense the wisher’s active electronics for the rest of contract.
I wish to leave	Unlocks exit during a hunt.	Wisher is slowed and vision reduced briefly.
I wish for life	Revives first dead player.	50% chance the wisher dies in exchange.
I wish for knowledge	Eliminates an incorrect evidence option / associated ghost possibilities.	Ghost teleports near wisher and cursed hunts; permanent dark/muffled perception penalty.
I wish for [weather]	Changes weather.	Temporary blindness and sanity cost.
I wish for anything	Random unused wish.	You surrender control of the downside.

8. Difficulty, Custom & Apocalypse

Difficulty	Unlock	Reward	Start sanity	Evidence	Setup	Grace	Key restrictions
Amateur	Base	×1	100%	3	5:00	5 s	Most forgiving; 50% insurance.
Intermediate	Lv 10	×2	100%	3	2:30	4 s	25% insurance; fewer safety margins.
Professional	Lv 20	×3	100%	3	None	3 s	No insurance; full standard evidence.
Nightmare	Lv 30	×4	100%	2	None	2 s	One evidence hidden; sanity/activity monitors disabled; fewer hiding places; kills can extend hunts.

Difficulty	Unlock	Reward	Start sanity	Evidence	Setup	Grace	Key restrictions
Insanity	Lv 40	×6	75%	1	None	2 s	Two evidences hidden; severe hiding/monitor restrictions.
Custom	Lv 50	×0–×15	0/25/50/75/100	0–3	Variable	0–5 s	Almost every mechanic tunable; v0.19 can force ghost type, setting multiplier to 0.

APOCALYPSE: The Apocalypse challenge uses custom extreme conditions on full Sunny Meadows. Reward tiers are associated with increasingly severe settings; the core skill is 0-evidence behavior identification under high ghost speed / low player safety. Practice on 2 evidence → 1 evidence → 0 evidence instead of jumping straight from Professional.

9. Media, rewards & perfect investigations

- Chronicle-style media rewards distinguish Unique from Duplicate evidence. v0.19 adds duplicate indicators directly to Photo/Video/Sound equipment, reducing guesswork.
- The first 5 journal photos count for photo rewards. Strong targets include Ghost, Bone, Cursed Possession, Ghost Writing, UV, used Crucifix, disturbed Salt and clear interactions.
- Video and Sound now matter as their own media systems; capture actual paranormal/evidence moments rather than filling the journal with repeats.
- A Perfect Investigation is a contract-completion package, not just “correct ghost”: correct identification, objectives/bone/media requirements and high-quality unique coverage all matter under the current reward system.
- Difficulty multiplier matters dramatically. Dying can erase efficiency even when your ghost guess was correct, so do not farm one more optional interaction after your information is already sufficient.

Reward component	Practical note
Correct ghost	Core payout; large maps award more base XP for identification than small maps.
Optional objectives	Usually small individual payouts; complete only when risk is sensible.
Bone	Always worth finding when practical; map size affects reward.
Unique media	Use higher-tier cameras/recorders for better value and avoid duplicates.
Perfect Investigation bonus	Requires a complete, high-quality contract rather than a single good photo.
Blood Moon / event modifiers	Seasonal or special modifiers can change reward calculations.

10. Maps & Restricted variants

MAP COUNT: The game’s base-location list is commonly described as 14 maps, with Restricted layouts treated as variants. v0.19 adds Restricted Prison, Brownstone High School and Point Hope in addition to Sunny Meadows Restricted.

Map	Class	Floors	Rooms*	Exits*	High-value field note
6 Tanglewood Drive	Small	2	12	1	Compact, forgiving; strong loops around dining/train-table/car-style furniture; excellent test map.
42 Edgefield Road	Small	3	16	1	Current released layout: dense/vertical; know closets before hunt range. A rework is announced for later 2026, not yet incorporated.
10 Ridgeview Court	Small	3	16	1	Dining/basement loop options; multiple floors can complicate audio.
13 Willow Street	Small	2	10	1	No classic closets/lockers; organic furniture hides; reworked in July 2026.
Nell's Diner	Small	1	14	2	Cooler Room can sit around 1°C with breaker on—temperature trap; open kitchen/dining loops.
Grafton Farmhouse	Small	3	14	1	Reworked layout; multiple furniture loops/hiding zones.
Camp Woodwind	Small	1	11	1	Open sight lines, weather exposure, limited walls; learn tent/furniture route discipline.
Point Hope	Medium	10	16	1	Vertical lighthouse; long travel drains sanity; stairs/pillars break LOS. Restricted variant is Small.
Bleasdale Farmhouse	Medium	3	21	2	Reworked farmhouse; larger than it feels, attic/vertical audio matters.
Sunny Meadows Restricted	Medium	Var.	Subset	1	Random restricted wing; smaller than full asylum but still complex.
Prison	Medium	2	Large	Multiple	Long corridors/cell blocks; v0.19 adds a Small Restricted version.
Maple Lodge Campsite	Medium	3	28	1	Large outdoor campground + cabin; generator travel and weather matter.
Brownstone High School	Large	2	64	5	Very long halls; v0.19 Restricted versions are Medium.
Sunny Meadows Mental Institution	Large	2	69	1	Five-wing megamap; full version used for Apocalypse challenge.

**Room/exit counts follow current wiki conventions where available. Restricted variants change playable areas and are not simply “same map but shorter.”*

Map discipline that scales to every location

- Before evidence: locate fuse box and a nearby safe zone. On large maps, cursed possessions can save enormous search time if you accept the risk.
- Mark “official” hiding versus unofficial furniture gaps. Aswang’s special weakness only recognizes official hiding places enabled by the hiding-place system.
- Looping is not equal on every map. A broad table that works on Tanglewood may be useless on Edgefield or a campsite because LOS cannot be broken cleanly.
- Outdoor maps make temperature and weather interpretation harder. Use a thermometer, not intuition.
- On multi-floor maps, audio above/below can mislead room location. T3 parabolic / directional tools and deliberate floor-by-floor sweeps are valuable.
- For Brownstone/Prison/Sunny Meadows, remote sensors and team role division save more sanity than repeatedly walking the whole building.

11. Solo / team workflows & community-tested tactics

Solo: efficient three-trip setup

Trip	Carry	Goal
1	Thermometer + EMF/Video + Flashlight/UV	Locate breaker, hiding, active area, possible Orbs.
2	DOTS + Writing + complementary evidence	Build evidence station and reposition camera.
3	Crucifix + protection / media tool	Secure hunt attempts, then collect objectives and targeted behavior tests.

Team roles that reduce chaos

Role	Job
Room hunter	Temp + EMF + map sweep; calls exact room/adjacent interactions.
Evidence builder	DOTS/Writing/Video/UV placement and repositions when ghost roams.
Safety lead	Finds hiding/loops, places crucifix, tracks sanity/hunt timer and carries incense.
Media / truck analyst	Monitors Orbs/DOTS/cameras/sensors, logs duplicate media, tracks evidence selections. v0.19 journal shows teammate selections.

Community-tested habits worth keeping

- “Two escape routes” beats memorizing one hiding spot. Hunt pathing, a roam, or a blocked door can invalidate Plan A.
- Light/noise/electronics discipline solves more deaths than fancy ghost knowledge: turn electronics off, mute, break LOS, then hide.
- Do not force 100% completion when the contract is already solved. Community advice consistently favors leaving alive with a strong answer over dying while farming one more optional.
- Learn zero evidence gradually: master Professional first, then Nightmare (2), Insanity (1), then true 0. Weekly challenges are good low-cost practice.
- When evidence seems “impossible,” first question the room. Multiple players independently checking for Orbs/Box/temps often catches a bad room assumption.
- Community cheat sheets are excellent for live play, but mechanics change. Use them as a fast interface, then verify surprising claims against current patch/wiki behavior.

12. Zero / low-evidence decision system

THE ORDER MATTERS: In 0 evidence, start with passive hunt observations that do not require standing next to the ghost. Only move into active bait tests after speed, audio, blink and sanity have eliminated safer candidates.

1. Is there a Ghost Orb on true 0-evidence? → THE MIMIC.
2. Does it sprint to every hiding player then crawl when close? → DEOGEN.
3. Is it very slow until it detects someone, then ~3.0? → REVENANT.
4. Does speed track room temperature with no normal LOS acceleration? → HANTU.
5. Did a fresh hunt start near 3.0 and remain fixed, then become slower after moving unique map props? → DEILDEGAST.
6. Does it progressively slow over the contract rather than reset? → THAYE.
7. Does it speed sharply around active electronics? → RAIJU. Breaker-on range burst? → JINN.
8. Does nearby player movement toggle 1.2/2.25? → DAYAN. Do footsteps drive a near-blind ghost? → KORMOS.
9. Do hunts alternate mild slow/fast values? → TWINS. Timed two-state + activity inversion? → OBAMBO. Protection-linked 3 states? → GALLU.
10. Does a slightly slow base accelerate unusually rapidly in LOS? → ASWANG.
11. Normal-speed group: test blink (PHANTOM/ONI/OBAKE), sound (MYLING/YOKAI/BANSHEE), salt (WRAITH/GALLU), light/door/object/flame behavior (MARE/YUREI/POLTERGEIST/ONRYO), incense timers (SPIRIT/DEMON), room confinement (GORYO/YUREI), and late/early thresholds.

Low-evidence rule-out logic

- On Nightmare (2 evidence), one of a ghost's normal three is hidden unless a forced-evidence rule applies.
- On Insanity (1 evidence), two are hidden; behavioral testing is not optional if several ghosts share the one clue.
- On custom 0 evidence, standard evidence tools can still help locate/interact with the ghost, but "negative evidence" means nothing. Mimic Orbs remain.
- If a forced evidence should be present and you repeatedly fail under correct conditions, reassess ghost room / equipment placement before ruling the ghost out.
- Never use activity personality as a hard exclusion. Even a Shade can have active windows; even a Poltergeist can spend time doing almost nothing.

13. Current traps, bugs & "do not rule out" list

Trap	Correct interpretation
Visible breath	Not Freezing evidence. Confirm ≤0°C / 32°F with thermometer.
No UV on one touch	Does not exclude UV; Obake is especially capable of skipping prints.
Book thrown blank	Only excludes Writing on a mode where Writing is guaranteed available as a normal evidence option.
No Spirit Box response	You may be outside same room/range, lights may be on, response RNG may fail, or Box may be hidden by difficulty.
Activity monitor spike	Not direct EMF 5 proof.
No Orbs in first camera angle	Ghost room may be wrong, Orbs may be occluded, favorite room may have moved. Sweep multiple angles.
Salt untouched	Wraith is likely only if you verified the ghost crossed it; enraged Gallu can also ignore salt.
"Fast ghost"	At least a dozen ghosts can be fast for different reasons. Identify the condition that makes it fast.
"Quiet ghost"	RNG. Obambo aggressive is intentionally low activity; Shade is shy; many normal ghosts can simply roll quiet.
Hunt started early	Could be ghost threshold, ability, cursed possession, custom setting, average-sanity math or a player-specific Banshee condition.
Gallu salt visuals in multiplayer	Earlier community documentation reports a non-host visual bug after incense in some states. Persistence in this build is not confirmed; prefer host observation and state-speed confirmation.
Aswang "safe spot"	Only official enabled hiding places trigger its no-kill hunt ending. Unofficial corners do not.
Oni event sanity values	v0.19 fixed singing-event collision to intended 20%; old sheets that say 10% are stale.
Old "new ghost" evidence sheets	Several third-party pages have carried outdated/incorrect evidence. Current evidence table + current patch notes win.
Tanglewood exterior glow	Official v0.19.1.0 known issue on Xbox/Steam: outside lampposts can glow incorrectly. This is not ghost evidence.
Custom fuse-box visibility	Official v0.19.1.0 known issue: the truck map can reveal the fuse-box location when Custom settings should hide it.
Old Kormos wall-kill claims	Fixed in v0.18.0.0. Sheets describing kills through walls or beyond intended distance are stale.

14. Dense quick-reference cards

If this happens, think...

Observation	Think
Orbs on true 0-evidence	MIMIC
One-blink model change	OBAKE
Photo makes ghost vanish	PHANTOM
Very visible hunt; never airball	ONI
Verified salt pass without disturbance	WRAITH / check GALLU state
Audio heard only very close	MYLING
Voice/electronics ignored out of LOS until close	YOKAI
Unique paranormal scream	BANSHEE
Multi-object explosion	POLTERGEIST
Instant light switch-off	MARE
Camera-only DOTS, empty room	GORYO
Door slam ability + sanity hit	YUREI
Flame count controls hunts	ONRYO
Fast in cold / no LOS accel	HANTU
Breaker-on range burst	JINN
Electronics speed zone	RAIJU

Observation	Think
Fast far / crawl close	DEOGEN
Slow search / 3.0 detected	REVENANT
Progressively ages/slows	THAYE
Faster as sanity falls	MOROI
Movement near toggles 1.2/2.25	DAYAN
Footsteps drive blind pursuit	KORMOS
Map props slow next hunt	DEILDEGAST
Rapid LOS accel from ~1.53	ASWANG
Protection creates 3 states	GALLU
Timed 10%/65% state cycle	OBAMBO
Incense blocks hunts ~180 s	SPIRIT
Incense only ~60 s / 20 s cooldown	DEMON
Alternating mild hunt speeds	TWINS
Very shy; ~35% threshold	SHADE

Hunt survival card

Do	Do NOT
Pre-check hides + two routes.	Assume favorite room is where hunt will start.
Turn handheld electronics OFF before hiding.	Carry a powered camera/flashlight into the closet.
Break LOS before entering hide.	Let the ghost watch you enter.
Save sprint for sight breaks / route transitions.	Sprint continuously and arrive exhausted.
Carry incense for deliberate tests.	Test a fast ghost with no protection.
Loop Deogen.	Hide from Deogen.
Stop / crouch carefully around Kormos.	Panic sprint near Kormos.
Question every “fast ghost” by condition.	Call Raiju/Jinn/Hantu just because footsteps are fast.

15. Sources & update log

Source hierarchy: official Kinetic Games announcements establish released changes and announced plans. Community mechanics sources support the detailed ghost tables. Revision checked October 29, 2026 against Development Preview 22, current official patch listings and event notices. The October 21 PS5 cosmetic hotfix is reported separately because its original Discord notice was not directly accessible. New features remain outside the released mechanics tables until launch.

- Kinetic Games — Phasmophobia v0.19.0.0: Quality of Life Part 2
- Kinetic Games — Quality of Life Part 2 Preview / Restricted map classes
- Phasmophobia Wiki — Evidence
- Phasmophobia Wiki — Guides: Identifying ghosts
- Phasmophobia Wiki — Hunt
- Phasmophobia Wiki — Incense
- Phasmophobia Wiki — Crucifix
- Phasmophobia Wiki — Cursed Possession + individual cursed-item pages
- Phasmophobia Wiki — Equipment + evidence-equipment pages
- Phasmophobia Wiki — Difficulty
- Ty Bayn live Phasmophobia cheat sheet (community quick-reference)
- Reddit r/PhasmophobiaGame — 2026 zero-evidence / beginner / new-ghost community testing
- Steam Community — current 2026 ghost behavior guide used as a cross-check

Update log

Date / version	What this edition accounts for
Aug 25, 2026 — v0.19.0.0	Restricted Prison/Brownstone/Point Hope; duplicate media indicators; teammate evidence/ghost selections; “Items We’ve Found”; custom ghost selection; Oni singing-event sanity fix.
Jul 21–28, 2026 — v0.18.x	Willow rework / QoL Part 1; Deildegast introduced into the current 30-ghost pool and community mechanics matured after release.
2026 ghost updates	Dayan, Gallu, Obambo, Aswang, Kormos and Deildegast mechanics integrated into tables/zero-evidence decision system.

Date / version	What this edition accounts for
This rebuild	Converted prior “second-screen cheat sheet” into a dense printable field manual with full dossiers, tier mechanics, maps, cursed items, low-evidence systems and community-tested traps.
September 9, 2026 — lore expansion	Pronunciation and cultural lore for all 30 dossier names; new game-world history and lore section; dated source notes and distinction between released content, interpretation and future 1.0 plans.
September 8 — v0.19.0.1	Prison Entrance gained props and UV interactions. Fixes cover Monkey Paw knowledge exclusions, Ouija answers, camera screens/tripods, UV charging, Restricted-map hides, bone, fuse box and equipment placement. Added VR belt offset and improved grip positions.
September 16 — v0.19.0.2	Fixed room entry for affected PS5/Xbox players and muffled multiplayer audio after a parabolic microphone was turned on and dropped.
October 7 — v0.19.1.0	Crimson Eye preparation, Seasonal Event toggle, revive and Easter Egg reward fixes, and two known issues. Section 18 gives the current event schedule and complete map list.
October 21 — PS5 report	Reported package 01.000.052 restored the Crimson Eye Twitch Drop tee. Original Discord notice not directly verified; no global mechanics change inferred. See section 18.
October 29 — editorial revision	Updated event status and charity dates. Added the October 27 Resonance preview as future content, retained released mechanics baseline v0.19.1.0, and dated outstanding issues.

Field glossary

Term	Meaning in this guide
Favorite / ghost room	The room selected as the ghost’s anchor. Most ghosts can physically roam away from it.
Ghost location	Where the ghost entity is actually standing right now; hunts normally start from here.
Base speed	Hunt movement speed before ordinary line-of-sight acceleration or a special conditional modifier.
LOS	Line of sight. Most ghosts accelerate while continuously seeing a player; breaking LOS interrupts the chase logic.
Hunt attempt	The moment the ghost tries to start a hunt. A crucifix can block an attempt before the hunt exists.
Forced evidence	Evidence guaranteed on 1–2-evidence modes for certain ghosts; disabled on true 0-evidence.
Official hiding spot	A hiding zone controlled by the map/difficulty hiding-place system, not an improvised furniture corner.
Cleansing	Using incense close enough to the non-hunting ghost to start the hunt-prevention timer and any ghost-specific effects.
Cursed hunt	A hunt forced by cursed-item mechanics; 1 s grace by default and permanently lengthens later hunts in the contract.
Strong tell	A distinctive mechanic worth building an identification around; still verify settings/state when another ghost can imitate it.

LIVING GUIDE: Phasmophobia is actively updated. When a patch changes ghost evidence, speed, sanity thresholds, equipment, map layouts or bugs, edit the matrix, dossier and quick-reference card together so the print copy cannot contradict itself.

16 Phasmophobia lore history and worldbuilding

Phasmophobia tells most of its story through places, props, recurring imagery and the work of investigating. This section contains spoilers for environmental clues and secrets. It separates what the game or developer explicitly presents from interpretations that help connect the clues. Research checked September 9, 2026; the gameplay guide retains its v0.19.1.0 baseline.

How to read the evidence for a story

Confirmed or documented: a detail appears in the game, its text or an official announcement. Community-documented observations are useful but remain distinct from direct developer explanations. Interpretation: a plausible connection between observations that the game has not explicitly settled. Community theory: a proposed explanation, name or chronology that requires further evidence. Announced future content: an official plan that is not yet part of the released game.

These labels matter because a location can contain a fixed corpse, photograph or written clue while its contract ghost is generated separately. Seeing the same model or prop in different places does not by itself prove that a single person is moving between every haunting. An evocative object also need not be a clue to a complete hidden murder plot. [G2]

The investigators and the haunted world

Confirmed premise: the players are paranormal investigators entering haunted locations to gather evidence using specialist equipment. The surrounding work routine—briefing, truck, journal, optional objectives, money and equipment—presents investigation as an organized occupation. The tension comes from learning enough to identify the entity while the act of investigating exposes the team to danger. [G1]

Worldbuilding interpretation: ordinary homes, workplaces and public institutions remain recognizable, making their supernatural intrusions disturbing. Equipment turns an invisible presence into incomplete readings: a voice, a trace, a temperature or an image. The journal’s categories provide a practical professional vocabulary inside this fictional world. Their authority within a contract should not be confused with an accurate taxonomy of real religions or folklore.

Gameplay and narrative have different jobs. A successful contract ends with evidence and identification; it does not ordinarily include a witnessed exorcism or show a spirit being released. The game does not provide a complete organization chart for the investigators or a documented explanation for every return visit. Repeat contracts are therefore a weak basis for inventing a continuous biography for a resident or ghost. [G1, G2]

Ghost type model and personal identity

Community-documented structure: the contract combines a ghost type with an individual name and other identity properties, including a physical model. The type chiefly describes rules and behavior. The model is its visible representation. The name identifies the entity for that investigation. These layers can interact, but they are not interchangeable, and models generally do not uniquely identify types. [G2]

Interpretation: the use of names from many traditions produces a shared horror vocabulary. It does not establish that every story from those traditions is literally true within the game. For example, a Goryo dossier and an Onryo dossier describe different game rules even though the cultural concepts overlap; a Jinn contract does not explain the whole cosmology of jinn belief. The folklore notes beside each dossier supply that missing context.

Patient 07 and the move from Asylum

Documented clues: the earlier Asylum contained UV-revealed writing about hoping to leave for Sunny Meadows, together with tally marks. The female patient model carried a Patient 07 label. In Sunny Meadows, a padded room contains many more UV tally marks and bloodied handprints, and the morgue includes a corpse associated with that model. These details form the clearest recurring personal story in the older environmental lore. [G3, G10]

Strong interpretation: the patient hoped a transfer would bring recovery, endured further suffering and died at Sunny Meadows. The poignant element is the contrast between the hoped-for refuge and the ruined institution players explore. The environment supports mistreatment and a tragic outcome, but it does not supply a complete medical history, named perpetrator or precise cause of death. [G10]

Community theory: players often call the character Lisa and turn the tally totals into an exact number of years in confinement. Treat the nickname as community terminology and the chronology as conditional: a tally need not represent one day, and the writing is not a dated admission record. Stories identifying a particular doctor, diagnosis or ritual cause go beyond the clues listed here. Reddit discussions and video reconstructions are valuable guides to observations, but their connective narration is not automatically canon. [G11]

Sunny Meadows as an institutional horror setting

Documented environment: patient wings, a chapel, restricted rooms and a morgue put care, confinement, religion and death in one building. Their dereliction suggests a place where treatment failed, without supplying a chronology of its closure. This fictional horror setting is not a description of real psychiatric care. [G3]

The chapel's summoning-circle secret includes inverted or burning crosses. It confirms deliberate occult imagery, not a particular contract ghost or a named cult behind every death. A fixed map secret and the generated ghost type answer different questions. Section 7 supplies the cursed-possession mechanics. [G3]

Point Hope and the drowned

Documented clues: Point Hope's entrance plaque places the lighthouse in Massachusetts and gives 1802 as its construction year. The Ferryman of the Drowned puzzle culminates in a spectral display around the lighthouse and awards an associated ID card. Together, the coastal setting, the drowned figures and the ferryman wording create a distinct maritime death motif. [G4]

Interpretation: the lighthouse can be read both as a guide for ships and as a threshold between the living and the dead. "Ferryman" evokes the widespread story image of passage into an afterlife. It is a thematic parallel, not confirmation that the Greek Charon personally exists here. The puzzle does not establish a victim list, a particular shipwreck or a single culprit unless further text supplies those details. [G4]

Homes workplaces and histories left in objects

Official direction: Kinetic described reworked Willow as a place with a story to piece together, continuing its approach to Tanglewood. Familiar rooms can acquire a different emotional history through photographs, everyday objects and interactions. [G8]

Interpretation should begin with the smallest claim the object supports. A hobby table suggests an interest; it does not alone identify a victim. A damaged room suggests disturbance; it does not name a murderer. Houses, farmhouses, the school, prison, campsites and diner each provide a setting for loss or danger, but atmosphere is not a license to fill missing backstories with invented crimes. Compare clues within the same released map version before combining old screenshots with new layouts.

The Blood Moon and the Crimson Eye

Official event fiction: the Crimson Eye announcement uses a cult-like invocation directed toward an entity or power associated with a blood-red moon. The prose asks for servants, otherworldly access and a promised finality or utopia. The event's imagery and named rewards reinforce that devotional framework. These are deliberate pieces of game fiction rather than fan-created labels. [G5]

Confirmed gameplay association: Blood Moon conditions make investigations more dangerous and alter rewards. Narrative interpretation: the ritual language suggests people trying to contact or welcome something beyond ordinary hauntings. It leaves major

questions unresolved, including the cult's full membership, the literal identity of the Crimson Eye and how widely its influence extends. Do not assume that every summoning circle or red mark elsewhere proves a connection. [G5]

Cursed Hollow and Winter's Jest

Official event history: Cursed Hollow adds a seasonal ritual framework and supernatural imagery to selected locations. Its event objectives and rewards belong to a particular release and can change on return. These seasonal stories broaden the setting, but the existence of an event does not establish a complete chronology connecting every haunting. [G6]

Winter's Jest explicitly brings Krampus into its event fiction. The 2025 event used jack-in-the-box objects and a bag of gifts with a Naughty or Nice list, turning familiar holiday imagery into a threatening exchange. This is the game's adaptation of a traditional seasonal figure; its objectives and rewards are game-specific. An event manifestation is not an additional standard ghost type. [G7]

Cursed objects and bargains with consequences

The cursed possessions make a coherent narrative pattern: investigators can trade safety for knowledge, contact or control. A mirror offers a view, a board offers answers, cards change fortune, and a wish may grant help at a cost. These objects imply that the supernatural can be approached deliberately but is dangerous to bargain with. This is a reading of the mechanics already detailed in section 7, not a new set of gameplay rules.

Literary context: W. W. Jacobs's 1902 story The Monkey's Paw is a famous example of wishes producing devastating consequences. It is useful background for understanding the item's horror motif, without asserting an undocumented statement of direct developer intent. Likewise, real divination and religious practices have distinct histories; their presentation as interchangeable cursed equipment belongs to the game's fiction. [G12]

Release history and the limits of a timeline

Real release milestones are easier to establish than in-world dates. The game entered Early Access in 2020; Cursed Possessions expanded its dangerous-contact tools in 2021; Apocalypse introduced Sunny Meadows in 2022; Eventide added Point Hope in 2024. Later map reworks and seasonal events expanded the environmental storytelling. These are development dates, not dates when the fictional residents lived or died. [G9]

The early 2026 roadmap linked the planned 1.0 release with a horror and lore overhaul. The later Phasmophobia 2026 and Beyond announcement superseded that timetable, moving 1.0 to the second half of 2027. An old preview that says the overhaul arrives in 2026 should therefore be read as a former plan. [G13, G8]

Announced future lore and Conduits

Future content, not released baseline: Kinetic has announced Conduits for 1.0. These are items tied to particular ghost models, intended to replace the collectible Bone. The developer describes a Conduit as an attachment that keeps a ghost connected to the world and prevents it from moving on. Revised ghost models, including Patient 07, are also previewed. Their detailed stories and experiences remain subject to future release. [G8]

This gives an official direction for the worldbuilding: personal objects and particular ghosts may explain more of the haunting. It does not justify retroactively assigning a specific object or life story to every current model. Until that content ships, keep its proposed rules out of field identification and avoid treating preview images as completed narrative scenes.

A practical lore walk

For an exploratory session, record the map version, room and exact observation first. Then separate a short interpretation from questions still open. Sunny Meadows offers the patient-room and morgue connection; Point Hope offers the plaque and Ferryman imagery; reworked homes invite a closer look at domestic objects. Compare developer text, community screenshots and your own observations before turning a plausible connection into a stated fact.

Useful unresolved questions include the investigators' wider organization, the cult's full aims, the identities behind many ghost models and the histories of individual locations. An unanswered question can remain interesting without an invented answer. The strongest lore notes preserve both the clue and the uncertainty so they can be updated when the game reveals more.

17 Folklore pronunciation and lore sources

Checked September 9, 2026. Bracketed F references support cultural context; P references support language notes; G references support game lore. Official game announcements establish developer statements. Academic, archival and dictionary sources establish historical or linguistic context. Community wikis, videos and discussions are labeled and used with the limitations described in the text. Respelling is editorial and approximate, especially for Deildegast, Deogen, Gallu, Kormos and Obambo; it is not a claim of an official spoken standard.

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18 October 2026 update and Crimson Eye

Revised October 29, 2026. Latest numbered public gameplay patch located: v0.19.1.0. Crimson Eye runs October 8–November 1. The PS5 cosmetic report is separate. [U1, U2, U12]

Session settings and fixes

The Seasonal Event toggle enables or disables event-map content for a session. The patch smooths the revive white-light transition and repairs an Easter Egg reward unlock failure at a ×0 multiplier. Known issues: Tanglewood exterior lamppost glow on Xbox/Steam; unwanted fuse-box visibility on Custom truck maps. [U1]

The v0.19.1.0 notes announce no ghost evidence, hunt-threshold, speed, equipment-tier or cursed-possession changes. Keep the baseline tables for released play. The October 27 preview names the next major update Resonance and targets late November; section 19 separates these plans from live mechanics. [U1, U10]

Crimson Eye field notes

Event locations: 6 Tanglewood Drive, 42 Edgefield Road, Grafton Farmhouse, 13 Willow Street, Bleasdale Farmhouse, standard Point Hope, Camp Woodwind and Nell's Diner. Point Hope Restricted is excluded. [U2]

Earn points through investigations, optional objectives and Blood Moon totems. Blood Moon weather increases danger; keep event conditions separate from ordinary identification tests. Rewards include a seasonal tee, Beholder ID Card and badge, Blood Moon charm and an upgradeable trophy. Existing trophy holders upgrade theirs. [U2]

Expired: the tee Twitch Drop ended October 15 at 11:59 PM BST; double XP/rewards ended October 22. Crimson Eye ends November 1. The later charity notice dates Ghost Hunts for Hearts October 26–November 2. Participating fundraising streams offer the Advocate card/badge; an animated set depends on a fundraising goal. Check campaign availability. [U2, U11]

Corrections and source status

Retained corrections: Kormos through-wall killing was fixed in July; Aswang can revisit its remembered hide during grace; Dayan proximity spans floors; Obambo switches after one minute, then every two minutes. The latter mechanics are community-documented. [U4, U6–U9]

See section 15 for September fixes. Earlier known issues are dated reports; persistence is not guaranteed. Keep new behavior reports provisional pending reproduction or confirmation.

October 21 PS5 hotfix report

Reported October 21 PS5 package 01.000.052 restored the Crimson Eye Twitch Drop tee, according to a community relay of Discord. Original notice not directly verified; no PC/Xbox, crash, audio or ghost-mechanics fix established. [U12]

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19 Resonance preview and release checklist

ANNOUNCED CONTENT • NOT RELEASED AS OF OCTOBER 29, 2026

Kinetic's October 27 preview combines Unity 6 and the Content Update as Resonance, targeted for late November. An exact release date and final patch notes are still pending. [U10]

What is planned

- Dowsing Rods locate the Bone: Tier 1 gives a broad direction; Tier 3 improves precision and floor guidance.
- Sound Sensor map icons distinguish sound types on the player's floor and support movement-speed observation.
- New ghost-interaction voice commands also support Text mode; VR text users access commands through the watch. A Journal page lists phrases.
- Random-map selection gains custom pools and map-size filters.
- Unity 6 targets stability, memory and performance, with lighting, graphics presets, VR Eye Adaptation and colour-vision options.
- Player conduct warnings and report-outcome feedback are planned alongside Xbox Play Anywhere.
- The Player Character Visual Update is delayed beyond Resonance. Edgefield's rework remains planned for later 2026.

These are preview commitments, not tested live rules. Do not add Dowsing Rods to the current equipment list or use the new Sound Sensor interface as an available identification test yet. [U10]

After Resonance launches

Read the release notes before changing the edition label. Confirm each equipment tier's unlock, cost, range, limitations and controls. Verify whether any ghost numbers or evidence changed; update the matrix, dossier, speed index and quick cards together. Recheck event modifiers separately. Test map and media changes, then export and inspect a new PDF.

Until then, use sections 1–17 for the existing field rules and section 18 for current event and maintenance context. Preview artwork and demonstrations are not substitutes for final mechanics documentation.